> Wherever the comparisons have been made between free and closed societies—West Germany and East Germany, Austria and Czechoslovakia, Malaysia and Vietnam—it is the democratic countries that are prosperous and responsive to the needs of their people. And one of the simple but overwhelming facts of our time is this: Of all the millions of refugees we've seen in the modern world, their flight is always away from, not toward, the Communist world.

On this trip to Europe I wanted to accomplish something else besides convincing the Europeans I wasn't determined to lead the Western alliance into a nuclear war. When I had entered office, I'd been struck by something that didn't seem right: The democracies were up against an expansionist powerhouse that was trying all over the world to peddle its system, yet we who had the system of government that *worked* were doing nothing to sell our vision of freedom and the kind of system in which the people control government, not the other way around.

So when I spoke before the European parliaments I made the point that while the world's democracies might have differences among ourselves, we were united by the same system of beliefs: a belief in liberty and the rejection of the arbitrary power of the state, a refusal to subordinate the rights of the individual to the state, and the realization that collectivism stifles the best human impulses. The democracies, I suggested, like the Communists, should adopt a policy of expansionism: We should try to help the new countries of Africa and elsewhere embrace democracy and become evangelists worldwide for freedom, individual liberty, representative government, freedom of the press, self-expression, and the rule of law.

> Freedom is not the sole prerogative of a lucky few, but the inalienable and universal right of all human beings.